DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

Submitted by

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Introduction

This report documents my work for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project, completed as part of the first-year B.Tech curriculum at VIT Bhopal University. The project is structured around a scenario in which I take on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for helping my peers navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and responsibly.

Across five tasks, I have built a Digital Literacy Portfolio covering the following areas: creating a visual awareness infographic (Task 1), setting up a professional digital presence across key platforms (Task 2), exploring coding and collaboration tools (Task 3), drafting professional emails and an etiquette guide (Task 4), and researching cybercrime awareness (Task 5). All work is organised in a single GitHub repository, which forms part of the submission. No prior coding experience was required, and all tools used are free and browser-based. This report documents my process, outputs, and reflections for each task.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module 1 | 20 Marks

Tool Used

Canva (canva.com) — a free, browser-based graphic design tool with pre-built templates and icons.

Design Description

The infographic is titled "Digital Literacy: Your Superpower in the Digital Age" and is structured as a single-page A4 poster covering three core themes:

- What is Digital Literacy? - Defined as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies. It includes critical thinking, online safety, and responsible digital citizenship.
- Safe Internet Practices - Covers strong passwords, two-factor authentication, avoiding phishing links, and protecting personal data online.
- Professional Online Presence - Highlights LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle as key platforms; emphasises that your digital footprint is permanent and should reflect your values.

The design uses a blue-and-white colour scheme with section icons from Canva's free library and concise bullet points under each heading for easy readability.

Reflection

For this task, I used Canva, which is a free browser-based graphic design tool with a large library of templates, icons, and fonts. I chose it because it requires no prior design experience and is widely used by students for creating visual content quickly.

My infographic covers three key themes: what digital literacy means, how to stay safe online, and how to build a professional online presence. I used a clean blue-and-white colour scheme with representative icons to make the content visually accessible and easy to read at a glance.

One thing I found interesting while making this was how much goes into designing a single page. Every font size, colour choice, and icon placement affects how readable and credible the design looks. I initially packed too much information into the layout and had to significantly simplify my language to keep it clean.

One thing I found difficult was deciding what to leave out. Digital literacy is a broad topic, and narrowing it down to three focused sections while still making each meaningful required careful thought. This itself felt like a practical lesson in digital communication - being clear and concise is a skill, not an afterthought.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Module 2 | 20 Marks

Platforms Set Up

I created or updated accounts on the following three platforms:

Platform	Primary Purpose	How I Will Use It
GitHub	Code hosting & version control	Host assignments, projects, and eventually ML repositories
LinkedIn	Professional networking	Build academic network; apply for internships by 2nd/3rd year
Kaggle	Data science practice & competitions	Practice AIML skills using real datasets and competitions

Reflection

I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle as my three platforms, each serving a distinct and non-overlapping role in building a professional digital presence as an AIML student.

GitHub is essential for any programming student , it is where code lives, projects are shared, and collaborative development happens. I created a profile README with my name, branch, year, and a sentence about my learning goals. Over the next four years, I plan to host assignments, mini-projects, and eventually larger machine learning and AI projects here.

LinkedIn is the global standard for professional networking. While I do not have work experience yet, building my profile early with accurate education details means my network grows organically. By the time I am seeking internships in 2nd or 3rd year, my profile will already have a credible history.

Kaggle is directly relevant to AIML. It offers free datasets, structured learning paths, and competitions that bridge the gap between classroom theory and real-world data problems. Many companies in AI and data science review Kaggle profiles during hiring. Starting early gives me a head start on building a portfolio of data work.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice: HackerRank

Platform: HackerRank (hackerrank.com)

Challenge Completed: "Solve Me First" an introductory challenge testing basic input/output in Python. The problem requires reading two integers and printing their sum.

HackerRank is a competitive programming platform used by students to practise coding and by companies to assess candidates. It offers challenges across languages (Python, Java, C++, SQL) and topics (data structures, algorithms, mathematics) organised by difficulty. It is widely used in campus placement preparation.

Part B – Google Forms: Digital Literacy Quiz

I created a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The form is designed to test batchmates' knowledge of key digital literacy concepts.

Questions included:

- (Multiple Choice) What does phishing refer to?
- (Short Answer) Name one platform for showcasing coding projects professionally.
- (Multiple Choice) Which of the following is a strong password?
- (Multiple Choice) What is two-factor authentication (2FA)?
- (Short Answer) What would you do if asked to enter bank details via an email link?

Reflection

For Part A, completing the HackerRank challenge familiarised me with the platform's interface . understanding test case format, reading problem statements precisely, and submitting code correctly. These are skills I will need for placement aptitude rounds in later years. Even a beginner challenge taught me to read problems carefully, as the input/output format was strict.

For Part B, designing the Google Form quiz was more thoughtful than expected. Writing clear, unambiguous multiple-choice questions is itself a skill. I had to ensure that wrong options were plausible but clearly incorrect to a knowledgeable person , which required me to understand the topic deeply before writing each question.

Academically, Google Workspace tools will be invaluable for group projects, peer surveys, and event organisation throughout my degree. The quiz I built could actually be deployed as a real Digital Ambassador activity , which makes the exercise feel purposeful, not just a submission task.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette & Communication

Email 1 – Requesting an Assignment Extension

Subject: Request for Extension on Assignment Submission- CSA2001
Respected Professor,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension on the upcoming assignment submission for Fundamentals in AIML, which is currently due on 27/03/26.I have been working on the assignment diligently; however, due to typhoid and fever, I find myself unable to complete it to the standard I would like by the original deadline.

I would be grateful if you could grant me an extension of 3 Days. I assure you that I will submit the completed work by 30th march without fail.

I sincerely apologise for any inconvenience this request may cause. Please let me know if an extension is possible, or if there is an alternative arrangement you would prefer.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Warm regards, Lakshya Jain

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Email 2 – Expression of Interest in a Summer Internship

Subject: Application for Summer Internship Opportunity – B.Tech AIML Student

Dear Mr Smith,

I hope you are doing well. My name is Lakshya Jain, and I am currently a first-year student pursuing B.Tech in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning at VIT Bhopal University (Reg. No. 25BAI10994).

I am writing to express my interest in a summer internship opportunity at XYZ inc. I am eager to apply my academic knowledge in a real-world environment and am particularly interested in ML.

Although I am in my first year, I am actively building my foundational skills through coursework, online platforms such as HackerRank and Kaggle, and self-directed learning projects. I am a quick learner, highly motivated, and willing to contribute meaningfully to your team.

I would be grateful if you could consider my application or direct me to the appropriate process for applying. I have attached my resume for your reference.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the possibility of contributing to XYZ inc. this summer.

Yours sincerely,

Lakshya Jain

Reg. No.: 25BAI10994

Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist

Note: The full checklist is also saved as social-media-checklist.md in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder of the GitHub repository.

Reflection – Poor Digital Communication

In 2020, a senior employee at a major Indian company was terminated after a series of casual, informal messages sent in a professional group chat were screenshotted and shared externally. The messages intended as humour among close colleagues , contained comments that were perceived as offensive and dismissive of junior staff. The employee had not considered that a WhatsApp group shared with 40 colleagues was effectively a public space.

What could have been done differently: The employee should have applied the same standard of professionalism to digital communication as they would to a face-to-face meeting. A useful rule is to never write anything in a digital message that you would not be comfortable having read aloud in a boardroom. Digital messages are permanent, shareable, and decontextualised and the intent rarely survives the screenshot.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: UPI Fraud

Module 5 | 20 Marks

Case Study: The Wrong Transfer Scam

Type of Cybercrime: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

Riya, a 19-year-old first-year student in Bhopal, received a call from an unknown number. The caller claimed he had accidentally transferred ₹5,000 to her UPI ID and requested she return it. He sent a fake "transfer successful" screenshot via WhatsApp to build credibility.

When Riya checked her balance and found no credit, the caller insisted the transfer was "processing" and asked her to scan a QR code he sent to "return" the funds. He told her: "Just scan and enter your PIN , this will send me back my money."

Riya scanned the QR code and entered her UPI PIN. Instead of receiving or returning money, ₹8,000 was immediately debited from her account. The QR code was a payment request not a receipt. Scanning it and entering her PIN authorised the outgoing payment.

By the time Riya realised, the caller had disconnected. The fraudster used a mule bank account , an account opened in someone else's name making tracing nearly impossible. Riya reported the incident on cybercrime.gov.in but was unable to recover the money.

Targets: First-time UPI users, students, and elderly users unfamiliar with how QR code payments work.

Consequences: Direct financial loss (often unrecoverable), psychological distress, and eroded trust in digital payment systems.

Source: Fictional scenario based on common UPI fraud patterns documented by NPCI and Indian cybercrime reports.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching UPI fraud was discovering that the victim's mistake was completely understandable given how the scam is designed. The attacker exploited a genuine gap in public knowledge: most people do not know that scanning a QR code authorises payment outward, not inward. The phrase "just scan to receive money" is logically convincing to anyone who does not understand the underlying mechanics.

The one habit I will personally change as a result of this task is to never act urgently on any digital financial request. Every scam I researched had one thing in common: the victim was made to feel there was no time to verify. Slowing down even for 60 seconds to call a trusted person or check the official app, would break the chain of almost every fraud scenario I studied.

Conclusion

This project has given me a structured introduction to the practical skills that define digital literacy in a professional and academic context. Across five tasks, I moved from abstract concepts to real, hands-on outputs: a designed infographic, active profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle, a completed coding challenge, a Google Form quiz, professionally written emails, and a grounded cybercrime case study.

The most significant takeaway is that digital literacy is not a single skill but a set of habits: thinking carefully before communicating, building a professional presence early, verifying information before acting on it, and staying aware of online risks. Each task reinforced a different aspect of this. I begin my degree with a clearer sense of how to navigate the digital environment responsibly, and a GitHub repository that will grow alongside my learning over the next four years.

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